

GARY DAHNKE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Release Management and Application Delivery specialist with 30+ years across mainframe, distributed, web, and cloud environments.
- Strong background in software development, deployment, and production support, now expanding into AI-aligned workflows through Python, data analysis, automation, and data-centric operations.
- Skilled in diagnosing complex system and data issues, coordinating cross-functional teams, and executing full SDLC processes.
- Building capabilities in model testing, data labeling, and prompt engineering to support modern AI-driven delivery pipelines.

SKILLS MATRIX

Proficient:

SQL / Transact-SQL • JCL • Relational Databases • VS Code • MS Excel • MS Word • Data Validation & Quality Checks

Competent:

Python (PCEP & PCED mastery) • Data Analysis • JSON / XML • Release Management • End-to-End SDLC Execution • Incident Triage • Workflow Automation

Basic / Working Knowledge:

AI & Machine Learning Fundamentals • Basic Statistics • Prompt Engineering • Data Visualization (Matplotlib, Pandas) • Cloud Fundamentals • AWS (EC2, S3, IAM) • Linux • GitHub • DevOps • Terraform • Java • HTML • Agile • JIRA • COBOL • TSO/ISPF

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified AI Practitioner - Amazon Web Services (Issued Jan 2026, Expires Jan 2029)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals - Microsoft (Issued Feb 2026)
- PCED – Certified Entry-Level Data Analyst with Python - Python Institute (Issued May 2026)
- PCEP – Certified Entry-Level Python Programmer - Python Institute (Issued Mar 2026)
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner - Amazon Web Services (Issued Sep 2024, Expires Sep 2027)

AI & CLOUD SKILLS

Skills Summary

-AI Fundamentals (AWS, Azure) • AWS Cloud Foundation • Python for Data • Prompt Engineering • Data Quality & Validation

Tools & Technologies

-AWS (EC2, S3, IAM) • Azure AI Fundamentals • Python (Pandas, JSON/XML) • SQL

Practical Capabilities

-Apply ML fundamentals to data prep, evaluation, and labeling
-Automate repetitive tasks with Python and SQL logic

Career Alignment

-Positioned for AI-assisted data work and freelance data/AI projects.
-Ongoing development in data analysis to strengthen AI-assisted workflows.

PROJECTS

- **CVAT Data Annotation Portfolio** — ongoing; bounding boxes, polygons, segmentation masks, attributes, tags; building a multi-tool annotation portfolio.
GitHub: github.com/garydahnke/cvat-data-annotation-portfolio
- **Functional Exercises Impact On Weight Training Data Analysis Project** — ongoing; collecting data, building Python workflows for visualization and trend analysis.
GitHub: [functional-exercise-impact-analysis](https://github.com/garydahnke/functional-exercise-impact-analysis)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DXC Technology — Release Management Specialist

Remote | Nov 2021 – May 2023

- Defined and implemented Release Management processes for Finance and Accounting applications, incorporating structured validation steps and data-quality checks.
- Reviewed deployment requests and coordinated test-file processing to maintain stable upstream/downstream flows.
- Created application and runbook documentation for SAP-integrated Finance systems using clear, structured formats.
- Managed code changes across multiple projects to maintain test-environment stability and consistent data movement.
- Delivered research, documentation, and coordination work, identifying tasks suitable for automation.
- Technologies: JCL, REXX, Endeavor, SQL, TSO/ISPF, Control-M, Excel, Access, JIRA, ServiceNow

Artech LLC (Consultant to DXC Technology) — Release Management Specialist

Remote | Feb 2021 – Nov 2021

- Supported rollout of Release Management processes using structured review workflows.
- Reviewed deployment requests and applied data-validation logic to maintain test-region accuracy.
- Built mainframe utilities to streamline deployment reviews and job-change tracking.
- Ensured test-region stability by managing critical job changes and maintaining consistent data flows.
- Technologies: JCL, REXX, Endeavor, SQL, TSO/ISPF, Excel, Access, JIRA, ServiceNow

Collabera (Consultant to Nationwide Insurance) — Application Developer

Columbus, OH | Aug 2019 – Mar 2020

- Delivered analysis, coding, testing, and implementation for the Universal Reinsurance System.
- Ran and validated SIT and UAT job flows across multiple projects.
- Executed DB2 utilities for loading, unloading, and restoring test data.
- Corrected a major claims-processing defect using SQL-based diagnostics.
- Technologies: SQL, JCL, COBOL, DB2, VSAM, Changeman, CA ESP, Excel, JIRA

NCS Pearson — Professional Scorer (Seasonal)

Westerville, OH | Mar 2019 – Jun 2019

- Evaluated and scored 15,000+ student reading-comprehension assessments with consistent accuracy and quality controls.

Solu Technology Partners (Consultant to Nationwide Insurance) — Release Coordinator & Code Deployer

Dublin, OH | May 2017 – Oct 2018

- Coordinated 17 monthly and 45 weekly/off-schedule releases for the Annuities application.
- Led release orchestration across development, testing, management, and business teams.

- Tracked projects and change requests across test and production regions.
- Ensured code integrity, testing completeness, and stakeholder approvals.
- Rebuilt test regions, executed daily flows, and resolved CICS issues.
- Contributed to a major rewrite project across coding, testing, infrastructure, and installation tasks.
- Technologies: SQL, JCL, COBOL, Changeman/ERO, CA ESP, Access, GitHub, ServiceNow

The Judge Group (Consultant to JPMorgan Chase) — Application Support Analyst

Columbus, OH | Jul 2016 – Nov 2016

- Monitored 6,000+ daily batch jobs and 100+ CICS/Web Service processes.
- Performed Level 1 and Level 2 triage and coordinated with Level 3 support.
- Managed incident queues for 15 enterprise applications.
- Technologies: SQL, UNIX, JCL, COBOL, DB2, File-Aid, SPUFI

Meijer — System Monitor & Price Auditor

Lewis Center, OH | Oct 2015 – Apr 2016

- Resolved hardware/software issues for store systems and performed daily price audits.

Insight Global (Consultant to CenturyLink) — Application Developer

Columbus, OH | Apr 2015 – Jun 2015

- Enhanced Java-based e-commerce applications and supported internal customer-service tools.
- Documented development environment setup to reduce onboarding time.
- Technologies: Java, JSP, JavaScript, Spring, XML, Tomcat, WebLogic

JPMorgan Chase — Application Developer

Columbus, OH | Sep 1996 – Sep 2014

- Delivered analysis, design, coding, testing, and deployment for nine applications across multiple platforms.
- Progressed from mainframe development into distributed, web, and database engineering.
- Supported full SDLC execution across development, testing, implementation, and documentation.
- Gathered requirements, built mock-ups, and documented system behavior.
- Led SIT and UAT cycles and resolved defects through closure.
- Organized and supported implementation activities across numerous releases.
- Resolved application, data, and reporting issues for business partners.
- Troubleshoot coding, database, and network issues during 24x7 on-call rotations.
- Executed disaster-recovery testing to validate application restoration.
- Led a database server migration and SQL Server 2008 upgrade across 13 interfacing systems.
- Directed the BTS application migration from IBM WebSphere to Apache Tomcat.
- Rebuilt a failed Lotus Notes application within an existing Java web application.
- Earned a 1998 Retention Bonus awarded to the top 10% of employees.
- Technologies: SQL, COBOL, JCL, Java, JavaScript, JSP, DB2, Sybase, Oracle, PowerBuilder, XML, Control-M

Nationwide Insurance — Programmer/Analyst

Columbus, OH | May 1991 – Sep 1996

- Developed and supported Auto and Property/Casualty Agent Commission systems.
- Designed an automated report-balancing mechanism that detected issues earlier than manual processes.
- Investigated commission and report-balancing discrepancies and delivered documented solutions.
- Defined business requirements and created project estimates.

- Served as technology lead and transitioned into full application-lead responsibilities.
- Technologies: COBOL, JCL, DB2, IMS, VSAM, Syncsort

EDUCATION

The Ohio State University

Bachelor of Science, Computer and Information Sciences

GPA: 3.4

Dean's List: 9 of 15 quarters